

LISTENING

#9



1 - Listen to a conversation between two people discussing the weather and their experiences. Answer the questions to understand their observations, opinions, and expressions, and practice explaining phrases in your own words.

Small Talk: Weather and Life Experiences

1 - What are some reasons both speakers agree that they are having a beautiful day?
(List at least two.)

2 - Why was it said that it is hard to tell if it will rain tomorrow?

3 - What did the speakers say about the traffic?

4 - Where is the man from, and how long has he been in Costa Rica?

5 - So far, what is he really enjoying about Costa Rica?

6 - Is bad traffic a normal occurrence where they are, or is it just an isolated incident?

7 - Who is from Ottawa, Canada?

8 - How is the weather in Ottawa, Canada?

9 - How long has the man been in Costa Rica?

10 - What did the man mean when he said, "It seems like just yesterday"?
(Explain the expression in your own words.)

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

Small Talk at the Café

James was waiting in line at his favorite café on a rainy afternoon. The person in front of him, a woman with a bright yellow umbrella, turned around and smiled.

“Terrible weather today, isn’t it?” she said.

James laughed. “Yes, it’s been raining all week. I almost forgot what the sun looks like.”

They both laughed, and the conversation continued.

“Do you come here often?” she asked.

“Almost every morning,” James replied. “I work nearby, so this café is part of my routine. What about you?”

“I just moved to this neighborhood last month,” she explained. “The rain reminds me of my hometown in Seattle. I’m used to it, but I miss the sunshine too.”

James nodded. “I grew up in California, so I still find rainy days a little depressing. But I guess it’s a good excuse to drink more coffee.”

By the time they reached the counter, they were chatting easily about travel, family, and favorite foods. What began as a simple comment about the weather had turned into a pleasant exchange of life experiences.

Comprehension Questions

1. Where were James and the woman when the conversation started?

2. What was the first topic they talked about?

3. Where did the woman say she had recently moved from?

4. How does James feel about rainy days compared to sunny days?

5. What lesson can we learn from their small talk?
